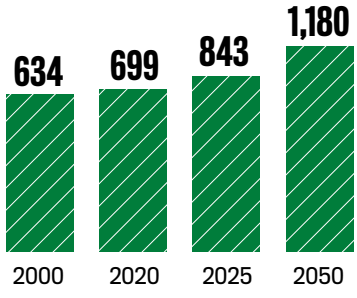


**HARVEST OF SUCCESS**
A farmer in Jalore district of Rajasthan uses sprinklers to water his fields in 2021

BANDEEP SINGH

## GROWING CONSUMPTION

(Billion cubic metres a year)




*Projected availability

**80**

PER CENT OF THE WATER USE IS DRAWN BY 140 MILLION HECTARES OF AGRICULTURAL LAND IN INDIA.




### MICRO IRRIGATION

An efficient technology for sustainable agricultural growth, it can increase yields and decrease water, fertiliser and labour needs. So far 137.80 lakh hectares of land have been covered under micro irrigation in India.

### NATIONAL MISSION FOR CLEAN GANGA

The Rs 20,000 crore-plus Integrated Ganga Conservation Mission launched in 2015 has made 4,465 villages across 52 districts in five states Open Defecation Free, before launching the river rejuvenation initiatives.

the Command Area Development (CAD) programme, launched in 1974-75, developed an adequate delivery system up to farmers' fields. It improved crop production. Soon, for want of copious water supply, participatory irrigation management through the creation of water users' association rationalised its use. But efficiency failed to gain ground. The advent of micro-irrigation to facilitate the use of sprinklers and drip irrigation created a sustainable participatory environment. However, the target to cover at least 10 per cent of the area under each CAD project with micro-irrigation is in the works.

Providing potable water, through a piped supply system to homes, has evolved from the earlier phases of drawing it from deep wells fitted with heavy-duty motor pumps, the ubiquitous community drinking water hand-pumps in villages, and the building of towering protected tanks. Since 2019, the Ministry of Jal Shakti has been implementing in mission mode the National Rural Drinking Water Programme. But the appreciation that water comes with costs and is a depleting resource is far from wide. ■